Staff answers

Tuesday 24 November 2026 | P6 | 40 minutes

Starter

On Model, C5 contains 2. B4 is column B, row 4; C5 is column C, row 5.

Model formulas

D4 =B4*C4 returns 6. D5 =B5*C5 returns 6. D6 =B6*C6 returns 4. D7 =SUM(D4:D6) returns 16. Changing Model B4 to 4 returns D4=12 and D7=22. Restore Model B4 to 2.

Task formulas

Use the same reference pattern with Task data: D4=12, D5=10, D6=8 and D7=30. In D7, =D4+D5+D6 is also valid. An entered 30 is not evidence of a formula.

Task change

When Task B4 changes from 3 to 5, D4 becomes 20 and D7 becomes 38. D5 and D6 stay 10 and 8. Two more paper packs at 4 points add 8 points. Keep B4=5.

Hinge

No: the typed 12 stays 12. Parallel check: =3*4 stays 12 because it has fixed numbers. =B4*C4 reads the input cells and updates when they change.

Transfer exit

3 packs at 6 points need 18 points. The quantity changed; points each stayed 6.

Checks and feedback

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Aspire

After core B4=5, set B6=0: D6=0 and D7=30. Zero means no fastener packs. A blank may mean data has not been entered, even if multiplication displays zero. Restore B6=4; D6=8 and D7=38.

Formula inspection

Check the equals sign and star. Check row numbers: D5 must use B5 and C5; D6 must use B6 and C6. A copied formula should shift to the matching row. D7 must sum D4:D6, not itself.

If a result stays fixed

Inspect the formula bar for a typed answer or fixed numbers. Replace with the intended cell-reference formula. If a correct formula still fails to update, check automatic calculation or recalculate in the spreadsheet. Record the issue instead of inventing evidence.

If an error appears

Check that inputs are numbers, not words or units typed into the cell. Check references, brackets and the initial =. If a formula appears as text, check the cell is not formatted as text and re-enter it.

One next step

Choose one: replace a typed result with a formula; correct one row reference; test one changed input; explain why the total changed. Wait for the learner response and acknowledge it privately.

Evidence boundary

Adult typing, a finished model or a screenshot of totals does not prove independent formula entry. Record what the learner chose and what support was used.